Rejected locations for the Red Sea crossing, Mt. Sinai and Kadesh Barnea

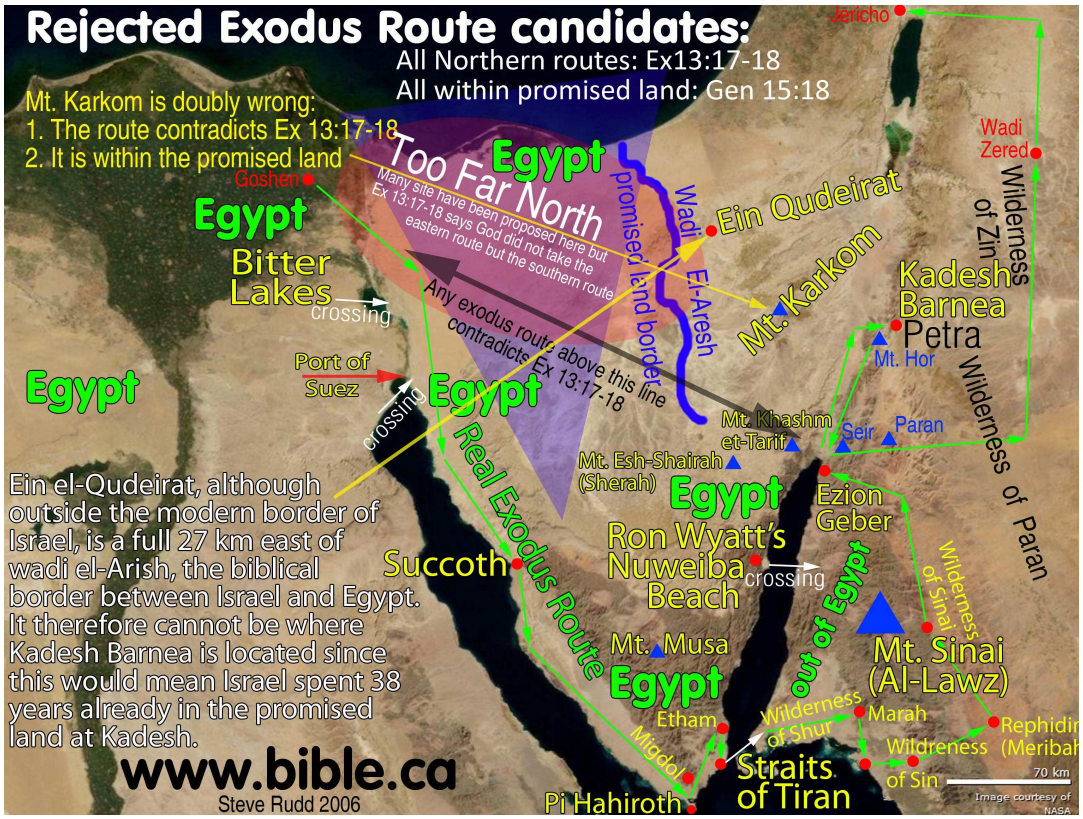


The Exodus Route! We propose:

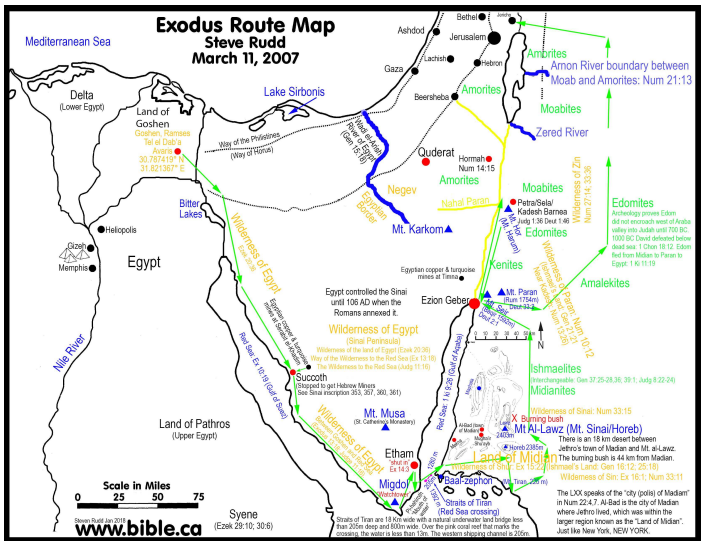
1. **ACCEPTED:** The Red Sea crossing at the Straits of Tiran
2. **ACCEPTED:** Mt. Sinai in Saudi Arabia
3. **ACCEPTED:** Kadesh Barnea at or just north of Petra

Various exodus route choices rejected and exposed.

1. Rejected Red Sea Crossing points:
    1. **REJECTED:** Nuweiba Beach: The impossible crossing As proposed by Ron Wyatt: The video "Exodus Revealed" and "The Exodus Case" by Lennart **Mueller** are all Wyatt's work. The Gold of Exodus is worthless to truth. "Ron Wyatt is neither an archaeologist nor has he ever carried out a legally licensed excavation in Israel or Jerusalem. In order to excavate one must have at least a BA in archaeology which he does not possess despite his claims to the contrary. ... [Ron Wyatt's work] fall into the category of trash which one finds in tabloids such as the National Enquirer, Sun etc." Archaeologist Joe Zias of Israel Antiquities Authority, IAA. Bob Cornuke's The **Exodus** Decoded, and video, "The exodus Conspiracy" are as worthless as the work of Ron Wyatt and must be discarded. Wyatt's archeological work on Mt. Sinai is also worthless, without any factual basis and must be rejected.
    2. **REJECTED:** Lake Sirbonis, Ballah Lake, Bitter lakes
    3. **REJECTED:** Port of Suez
4. Rejected Mt. Sinai candidates:
    1. **REJECTED:** Mt. Musa (at St. Catherine's monastery) Entirely Inside Egypt
    2. **REJECTED:** Mt. Karkom (Inside promised land)
    3. **REJECTED:** Mt. Khashm et-Tarif and Esh-Shairah or Shera (Inside Egypt, Midian must be located at El Bad in modern Saudi Arabia, overlooks the need to pass through Ezion Geber on route to Kadesh at Qudeirat, unless Kadesh is located at Petra)
4. Rejected Kadesh Barnea candidates: Ein el-Qudeirat



Exodus Route home page



Overview map
(Click on photo for high resolution)



Satellite map
(Click on photo for high resolution)

Introduction:

1. Many preachers realize that only 3 of the 50 locations are known for sure of the exodus route and conclude we cannot know and it doesn't matter anyway. Consequently, very little effort is put into analyzing many of the exodus routes.
    a. We believe it is as important to faith as it is to truth.
    b. We examined all the proposed exodus routes, Red Sea crossing points, choices for Mt. Sinai and Kadesh Barnea and have excluded many because they contradict the Bible or assault one's own common sense.
    c. There are very serious problems with the traditional exodus route which we will expose.
2. Ruling out routes that travel north or east:
    a. These routes that travel north or east contradict the Bible. They did not take the direct eastern route called "the way of the land of the Philistines", (Ex 13:17-18) which was also known as the Way of Horus", where Egypt had a series of defensive outposts filled with garrisons of soldiers dotted along this route. This rules out any Red Sea crossing points on the Mediterranean sea like "Lake Sirbonis" or "Lake Menzaleh".

b. Recently "Ballah Lake" has been proposed by James K. Hoffmeier in his book, "Ancient Israel in Sinai: The Evidence for the Authenticity of the Wilderness Tradition". This is a dried up lake that was drained when the canal was dug.

c. Ex 13:17-18 also rules out any candidate locations for Mt. Sinai north of the line drawn from Goshen to Ezion Geber (Elat, north Gulf of Aqaba)

I. Ruling out Red Sea crossing points:

Here are three crossing points which should be forever: Lake Sirbonis, Bitter Lakes, North Suez. We call it "red light, green light".

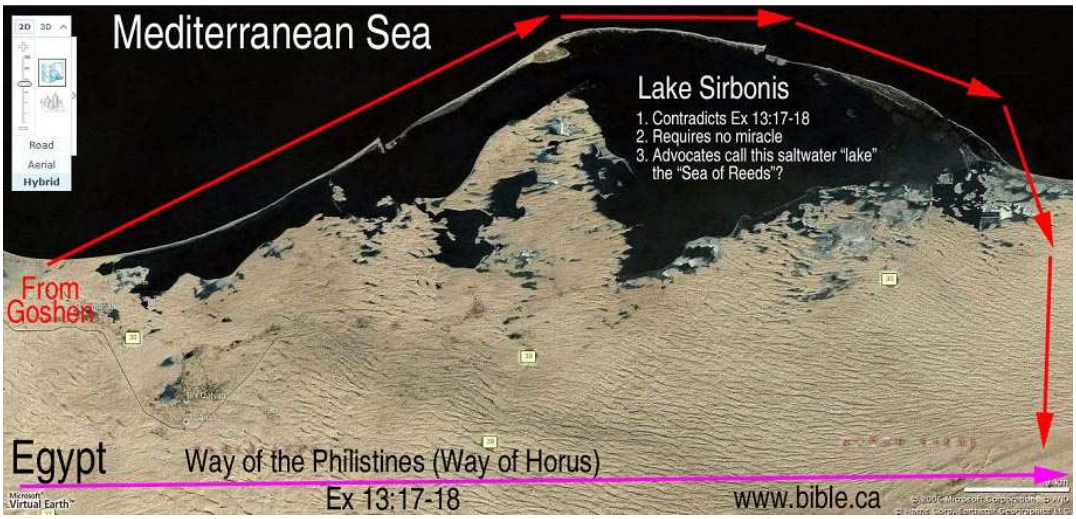
1. Green light is the actual exodus route down to the Straits of Tiran crossing over into modern Saudi Arabia where Mt. Sinai is located. (Jebel Al-Lawz)
2. Red Light (very bad choice): Lake Sirbonis "crossing" to a Mt. Sinai candidate north of the line between Goshen and modern Elat.
3. Amber light (illogical choice): Bitter Lakes crossing to Mt. Musa chosen by Queen Helena in 325 AD.
4. Pink light (best of the lot, but still wrong): Port of Suez crossing.



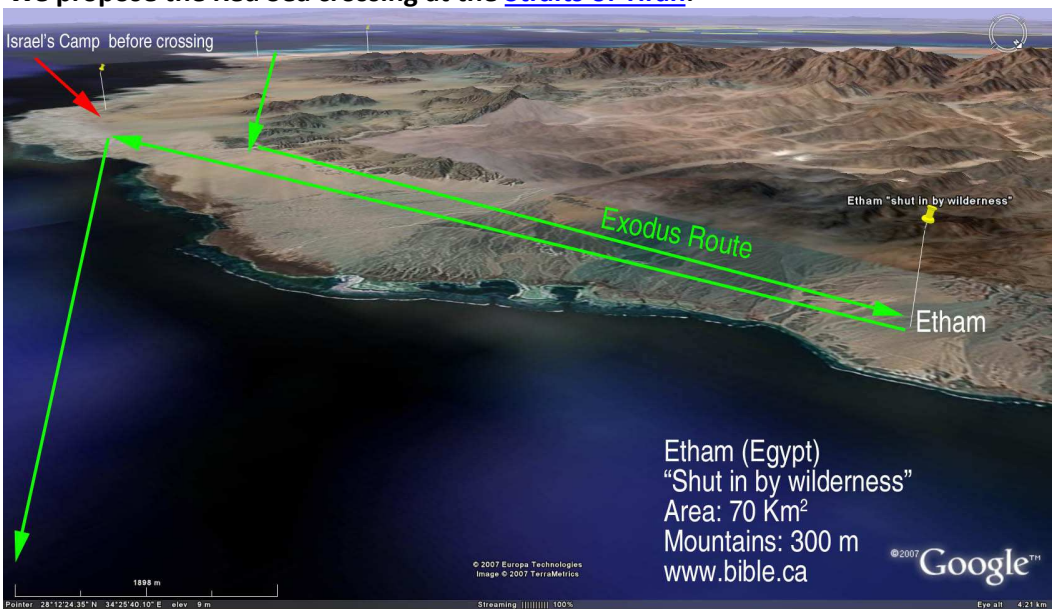
Green Light: Straits of Tiran. This is the true crossing point!



Red Light: Lake Sirbonis rejected for contradicting the Bible



1. **Contradicts the Bible**
    a. These routes that travel north or east contradict the Bible. They did not take the direct eastern route called "the way of the land of the Philistines", (Ex 13:17-18) which was also known as the Way of Horus", where Egypt had a series of defensive outposts filled with garrisons of soldiers dotted along this route. This rules out any crossing points on the Mediterranean sea like "Lake Sirbonis" or "Lake Menzaleh".
    b. No wall of water on either side: 1 Cor 10:1-4
    c. No wilderness before the crossing: Ex 13:18; Judg 11:16.
    d. Not far enough away to justify their bitter complaints about being in the wilderness: Exodus 14:11-12
2. **Denies the miracle**
    a. Chosen because wind can create a natural land bridge, therefore requires no miracle.
3. **Assaults common sense**
    a. Too close to Goshen.
    b. Army would never pass through the sea, but move to the "other side of the sea" as Hebrews exit the Sea.
    c. No security from Egypt on other side. Israel would not rejoice, they would keep running!
    d. Pillar of fire need couldn't hold back army and is still needed after the crossing point.
    e. Illogical route: Hebrews would have no reason to stop there, but keep running.
4. **Etham doesn't fit**
5. **We propose the Red Sea crossing at the Straits of Tiran.**



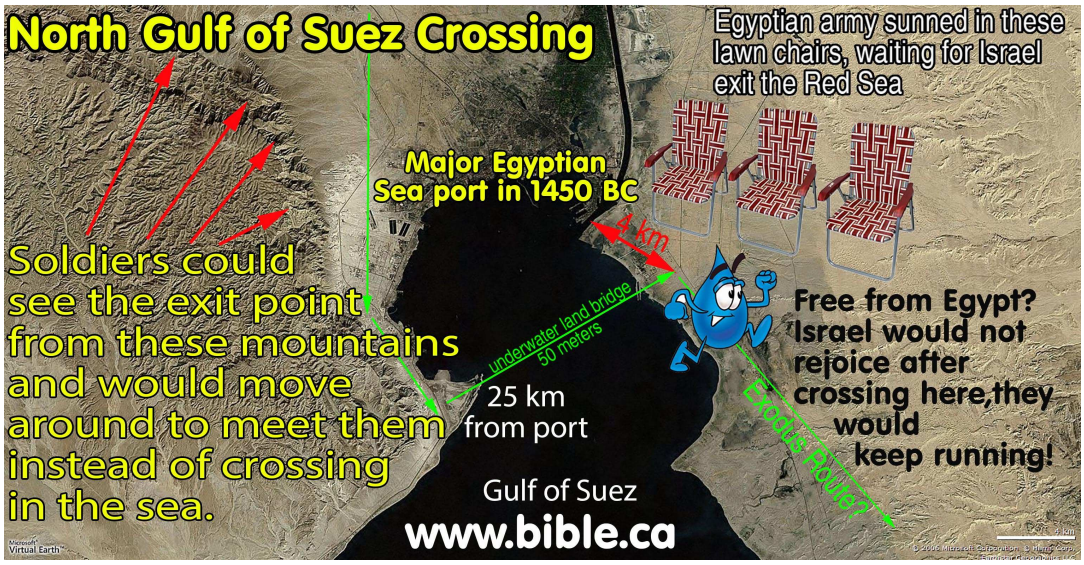
    a. The Mediterranean is beside a large flat plain with no mountains. Etham: no place for wilderness to "shut them in", doesn't pass the crossing point to Etham then return again and camp at the crossing point.

Amber Light: Ballah Lake and Bitter Lakes Rejected for being illogical

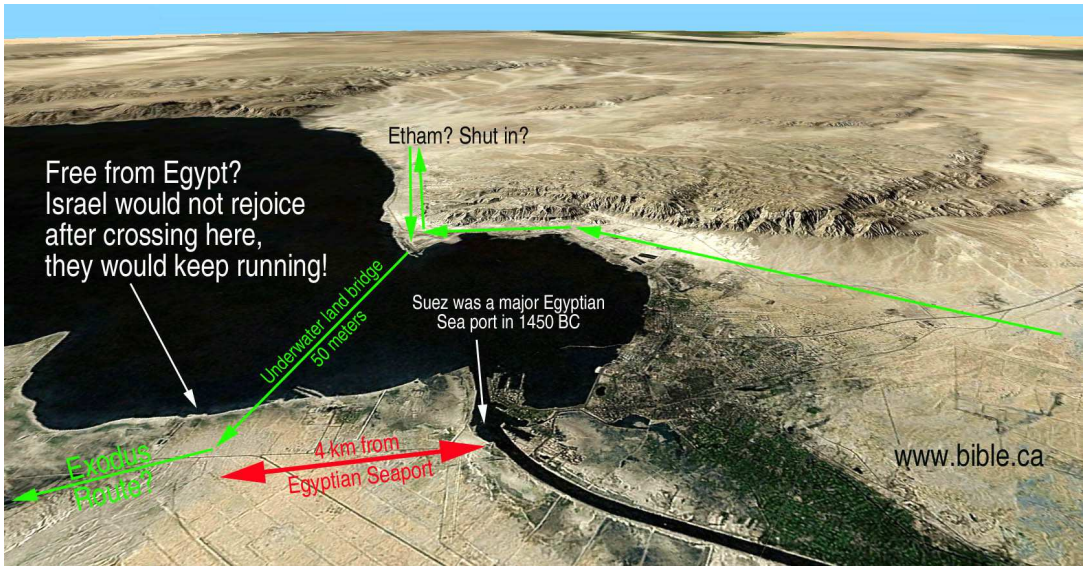


1. **Contradicts the Bible**
   a. No wall of water on either side.
   b. No wilderness before the crossing: Ex 13:18; Judg 11:16.
2. **Denies the miracle**
   a. Chosen because wind can create a natural land bridge, therefore requires no miracle.
3. **Assaults common sense**
   a. Too close to Goshen: 30 km: "Hebrew weekend fishing hole"
   b. It is not deep enough to drown the Pharaoh's army: Pharaoh's army sank to the bottom like a stone in deep, mighty, raging waters! Exodus 15:5, 10
   c. Army would never pass through the sea, but move to the "other side of the sea" as Hebrews exit the Sea.
   d. No security from Egypt on other side. Israel would not rejoice, they would keep running!
   e. No wall of water on either side: 1 Cor 10:1-4
   f. Pillar of fire need couldn't hold back army and is still needed after the crossing point.
   g. Illogical route: Hebrews would never stop there, but go around the lake and keep running.
   h. Not far enough away to justify their bitter complaints about being in the wilderness: Exodus 14:11-12
   i. Being a freshwater body of water, would provide drinkable water and food.
4. **Etham doesn't fit**
   a. Ballah Lake and the Bitter lakes are in the middle of a large flat plain with no mountains.
   b. Etham: no place for wilderness to "shut them in", doesn't pass the crossing point to Etham then return again and camp at the crossing point.
5. **Doesn't fit the context**
   a. Etham: no place for wilderness to "shut them in", doesn't pass the crossing point to Etham then return again and camp at the crossing point.
   b. We propose the Red Sea crossing at the Straits of Tiran.

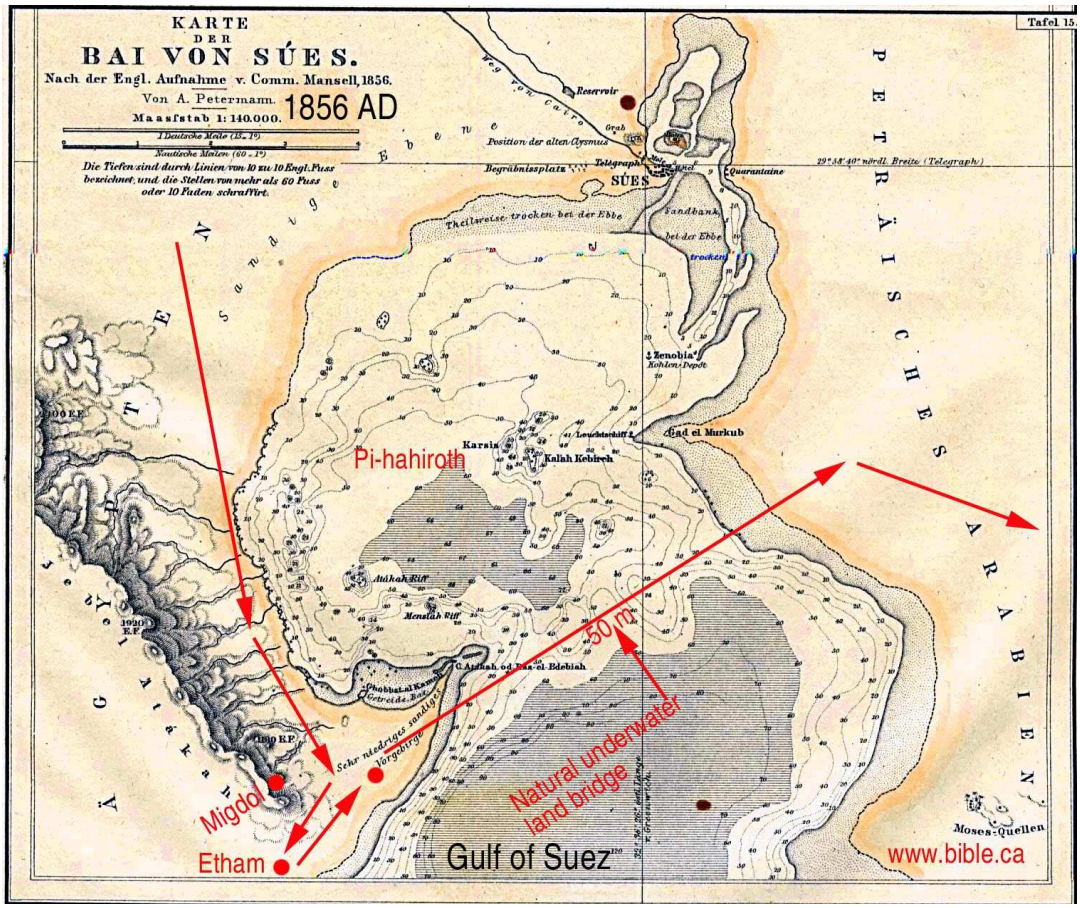
Pink Light: Port of Suez for being illogical



Most conservative minded, Bible believers have accepted that Israel crossed the Red Sea at the north Gulf of Suez. Yet there are huge problems with this choice. For example, the only element that fits the narrative is that the water was deep enough to drown the Egyptian army. Perhaps it is so popular because of no viable alternative. Yet the Straits of Tiran fit perfect, but most are unaware of it because they believe the exodus route is not real important and have never taken the time to look closer. Historically, the actual crossing point was determined by a natural underwater land bridge. You can see from the 1856 AD relief map below exactly where it goes. At the crossing point, they are 25 km from the port of Suez. After crossing they are only 4 km from the port. The Egyptian soldiers wouldn't bother following them into the sea, but would sit comfortably in their beech chairs in the sun and wait for Israel to come closer to them. The pillar of Fire would put the army towards the Port of Suez. If they stayed 10 miles back, they would not cross the sea, but go to the place Israel exited the sea. The pillar of fire was needed on both sides of the crossing point to protect Israel. The widely accepted north Suez crossing is an assault on common sense.



The land bridge is seen on this 1856 AD relief map:



1. **Contradicts the Bible**
   a. No wilderness before the crossing: Ex 13:18; Judg 11:16.
2. **Etham doesn't fit**
   a. There are mountains on the west side of the proposed crossing point but they never get any narrower than 800 meters which provides a huge escape path. After crossing past this 800 meter bottleneck, the terrain opens up to a huge flat plain.
   b. The Bible says they went past the crossing point, got "Shut in by the wilderness" then God told them to retrace their path back to the previous crossing point. It doesn't fit Etham at all since there is no place for wilderness to "shut them in", forcing them to return again to the actual crossing point they passed the day before.
3. **Assaults common sense**
4. **We propose the Red Sea crossing at the Straits of Tiran.**
   a. Too close to Goshen: 100 km.
   b. Too close to a major Egyptian sea port. The exit point is only 4 km from the sea port of Suez. No security from Egypt on other side. Israel would not rejoice, they would keep running!
   c. Army would never pass through the sea, but move to the "other side of the sea" as Hebrews exit the Sea. Better still, they may have watched from their beech chairs at the port of Suez and waited for Israel to move closer to them.
   d. Illogical route: Hebrews would never take this route, but take east side of the Gulf of Suez, then go south.
   e. No reason to pass the crossing point, get boxed in then return again. It is illogical to not just keep running down the huge open plain, then return and pass through the narrow 800 meter bottleneck.
   f. Also remember that the locust were blown into the Red Sea (Suez) and if this is the crossing point, then the locust would have been there only about 6-10 days. They would still be littered on the shoreline and floating on the water. (Ex 10:19)
   g. Not far enough away to justify their bitter complaints about being in the wilderness: Exodus 14:11-12
5. **Timing problems**
   a. For those who suggest the traditional route of a Suez crossing to Mt. Musa in 44 days there are grave problems. First they say it took 7 days to travel 100 km to the crossing point plus two days waiting for Pharaoh to arrive for a daily rate of travel of 14 km for 7 days. Then they traveled 250 km to Mt. Musa from the Suez in 27 days for an average daily rate of travel of 9 km per day. Although we do not know the days of

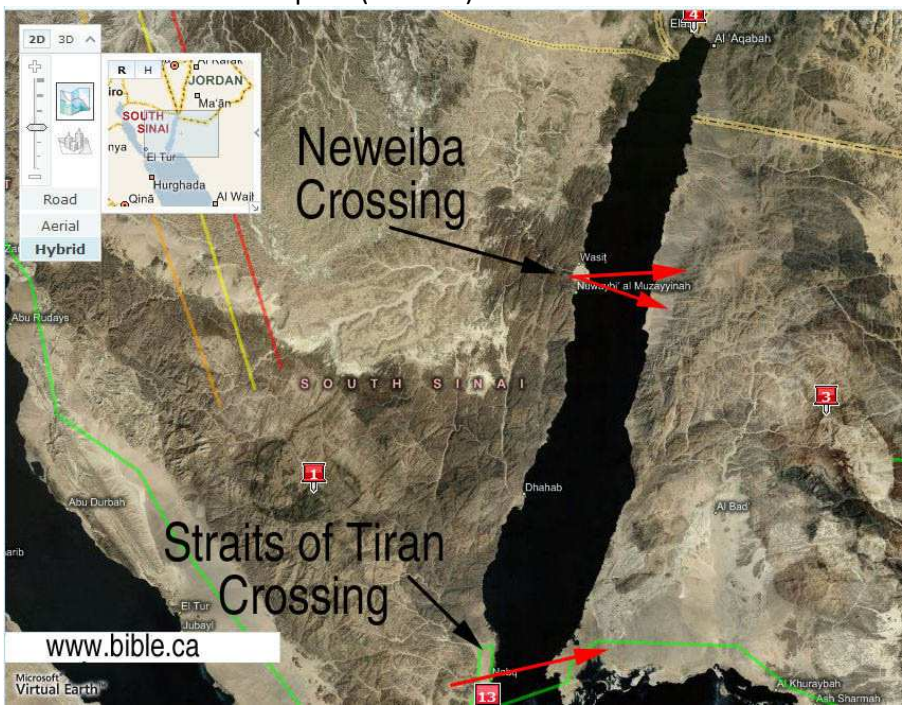
travel from Goshen to the Red Sea, we do know they took 20 days from the Red Sea to Sinai. We can therefore compute the trip from Goshen to the Red Sea as being 25 days. Ignorance is bliss for those who espouse the traditional exodus route and they have their times all wrong. The actual times are as follows: Total trip: 44 days. Red Sea to Sinai: 20 days. Goshen to Red Sea: 25 days. So the Hebrews took 25 days to travel 100 km to the Suez in easy flat terrain, then took 20 days to travel 250 km to Mt. Sinai in harsh mountainous terrain. For this reason alone the traditional route must be abandoned.

b. We propose the Red Sea crossing at the Straits of Tiran.

RED Light: Ron Wyatt's Nuweiba Beach crossing, Egypt rejected for being impossible

The video "Exodus Revealed" and "The Exodus Case" by Lennart Mueller are all Wyatt's work. The Gold of Exodus is worthless to truth. "Ron Wyatt is neither an archaeologist nor has he ever carried out a legally licensed excavation in Israel or Jerusalem. In order to excavate one must have at least a BA in archaeology which he does not possess despite his claims to the contrary. ... [Ron Wyatt's work] fall into the category of trash which one finds in tabloids such as the National Enquirer, Sun etc." Archaeologist Joe Zias of Israel Antiquities Authority, IAA. Bob Cornuke's The Exodus Decoded, and video, "The exodus Conspiracy" are as worthless as the work of Ron Wyatt and must be discarded. Wyatt's archeological work on Mt. Sinai is also worthless, without any factual basis and must be rejected.

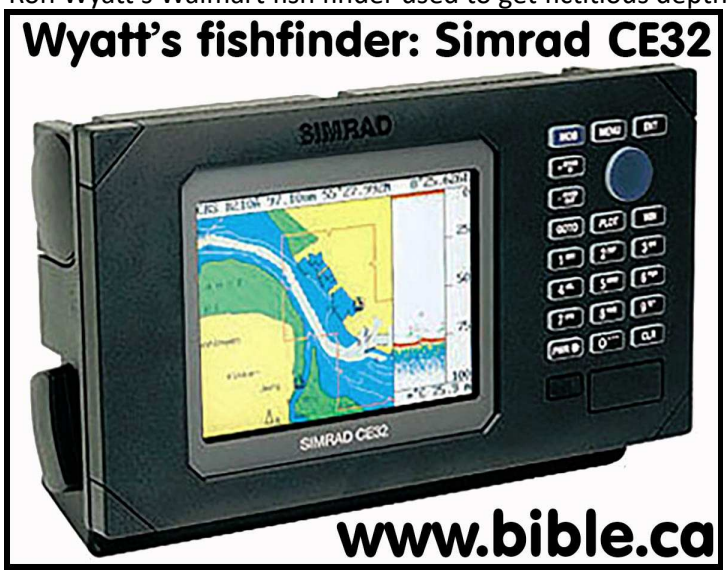
Nuweiba Beach crossing must be rejected: Nuweiba Beach crossing has been made popular by unsubstantiated and irresponsible claims of finding the chariot wheels of pharaoh's army at this point at the bottom of the Gulf of Aqaba. (Red Sea).





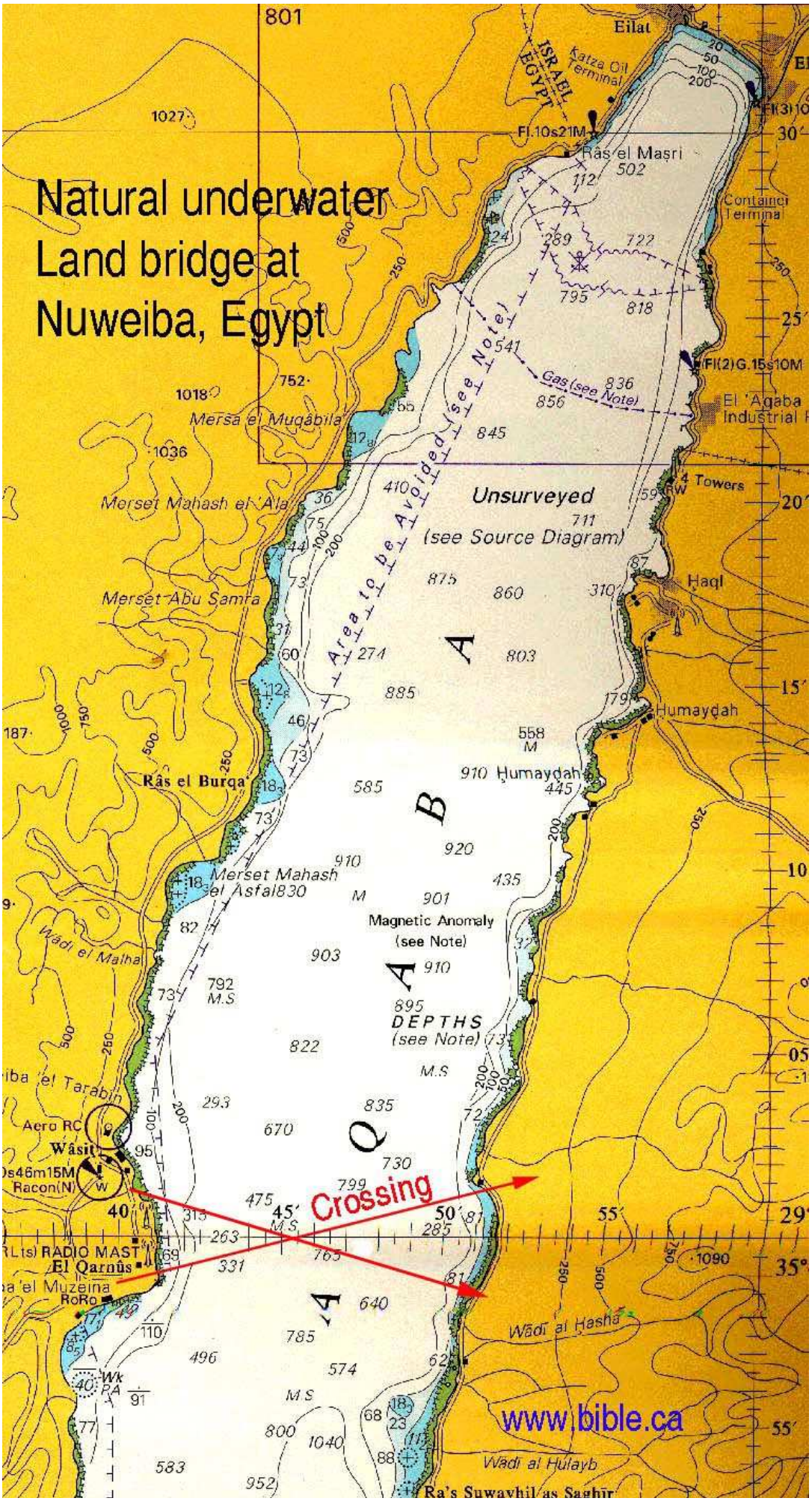
Wyatt's bad archeology exposed:

1. **Etham doesn't fit.** For this reason alone the Nuweiba crossing must be rejected.
   a. There is a very narrow access valley that is only 130 meters wide winding through high mountains to access this beach. Once at the beach, it is clear that the "wilderness of shut them in", but the narrative says they came to the crossing point, then went past to Etham, then turned back. There is simply no place to locate Etham because the beach is so tiny, (28 sq. km.) that Israel would take up all available space. There is no place on the Nuweiba Beach for God to tell them to retrace their path back to the red sea crossing point, forcing them to return again to the actual crossing point they passed the day before. In other words, the area is so small, that once you squeeze 2-3 million people with flocks and herds on the beach, there certainly is no room for them to go to another location (Etham) then return again.
   b. The straits of Tiran fit perfectly. They pass the crossing point them come to Etham. At that point they are shut in. Then God tells them to backtrack and retrace their steps and camp at the actual crossing point.
   c. This critical detail about Etham simply doesn't work at the Nuweiba Beach. If the Nuweiba Beach is where they were shut in by the wilderness, then they had to retrace their steps inland towards the north. Therefore the Nuweiba Beach simply cannot be the crossing point. Being trapped at the Nuweiba Beach with no where to go but inland is exactly what disqualifies this as the crossing point. The straits of Tiran fit perfectly because they came to a dead end, turned back and parked beside the Red Sea. This is impossible at the Nuweiba Beach!
   d. **We propose the Red Sea crossing at the Straits of Tiran.**
2. Ron Wyatt's Walmart fish finder used to get fictitious depth readings:



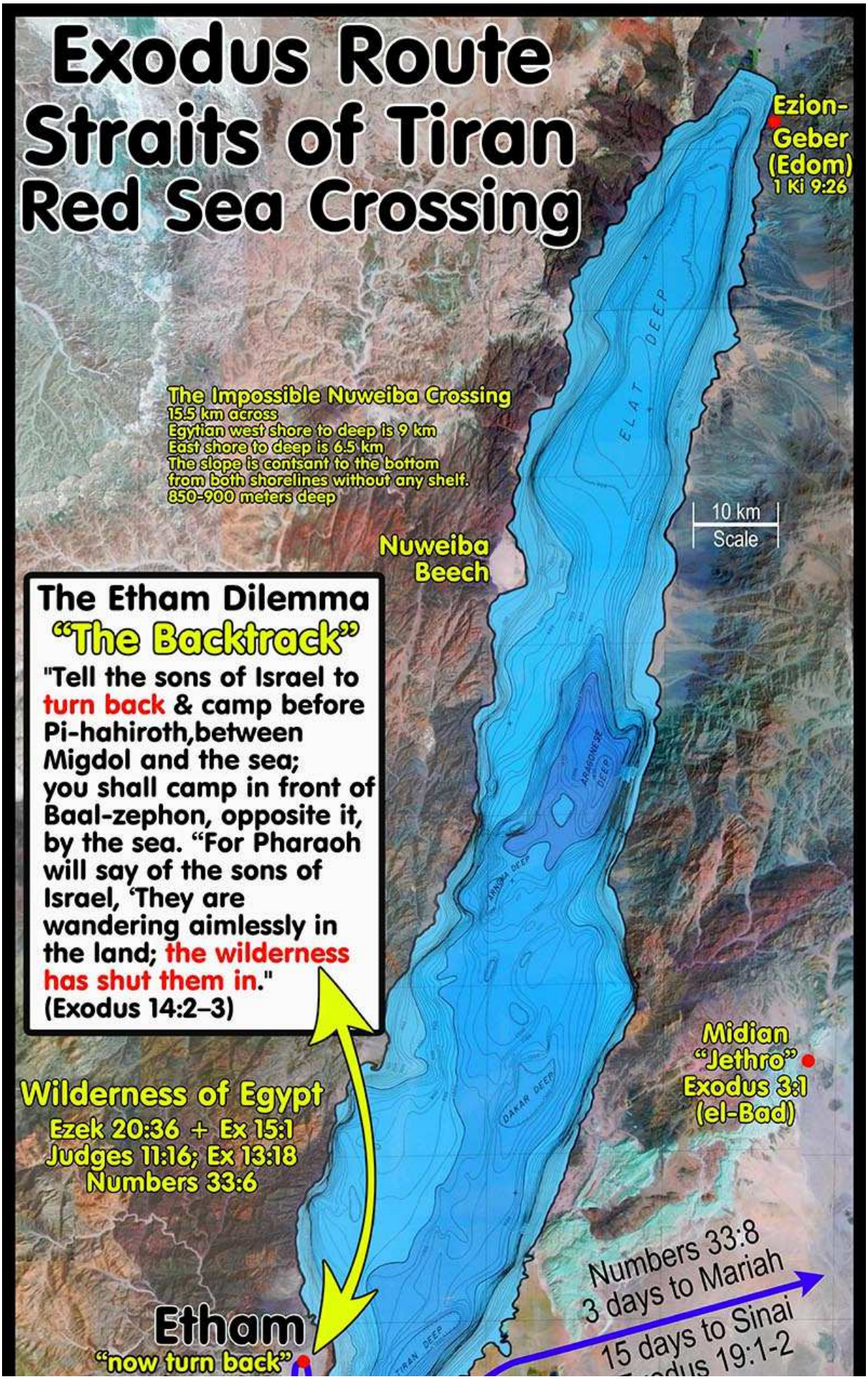
a. Regardless of the capacities of this fish finder, Wyatt never went across the gulf of Aqaba to take readings. The fact that he only took readings to the 100 meter depth then extrapolated the depth to 240 meters. 100 Meters is less than 1 km from the shore. So either way, if the fish finder could read the bottom at 900 meters, HE DID NOT MEASURE IT. We know, however, that the machine he was using would likely “zero out” around 400 meters. Even here, if he estimated the bottom was only 240 meters, WHY DID HE NEED TO EXTRAPOLATE that depth? Shoddy science.
b. Wyatt collected the data to produce the above contour maps by using a small portable fish finder "Simrad CE32" that has a max rated depth of 350 meters at 200 kHz and 800m at 50 kHz according to the owners manual.
c. The actual depth that can be relied upon is MUCH less, given the downward beam is 45-degree angle wide.
d. The manual says that to reach 800 m: "use the 50 kHz for searching in a wider area, determining bottom conditions and going the deepest.
e. The transmitter has a wide transmitter beam with a 45° opening." What do you expect from a home fish finder?
f. The actual depth is 850-950 meters at the bottom of the trench.

3. **Natural underwater land bridge**
   a. **British admiralty nautical depth chart 12**

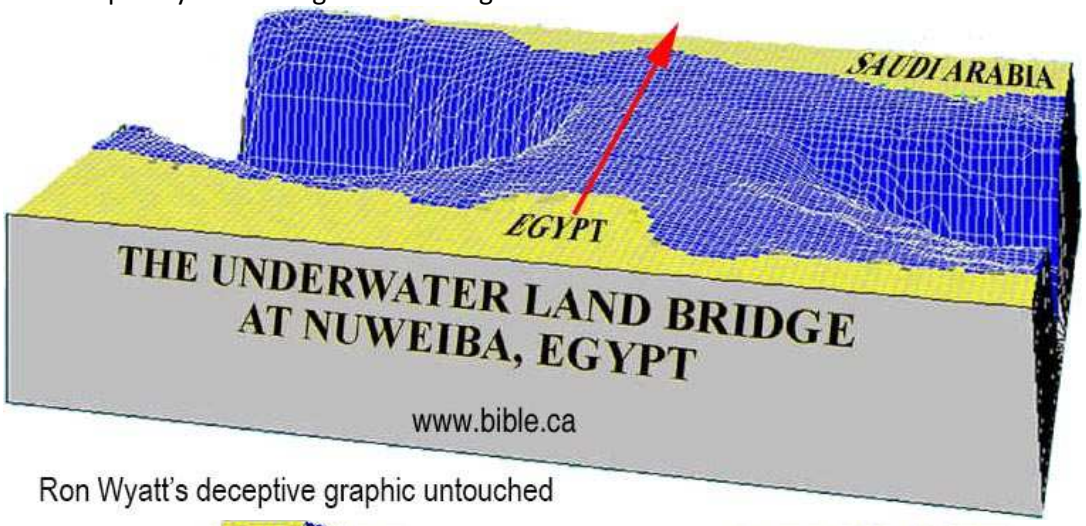

Natural underwater
Land bridge at
Nuweiba, Egypt
Crossing
www.bible.ca
Eilat
ISRAEL
EGYPT
Katza Oil Terminal
Fl.10s21M
Râs el Masri
Container Termina
Fl(2)G.15s10M
El 'Aqaba Industrial
4 Towers
Area to be Avoided (see Note)
Gas (see Note)
Unsurveyed
(see Source Diagram)
Haql
Humaydah
910 Humaydah
Râs el Burqa'
Merset Mahash el Asfal
Magnetic Anomaly
(see Note)
DEPTHS
(see Note)
Aero RC
Wâsit
Fl.10s46m15M
Racon(N)
RADIO MAST
El Qarnûs
el Muzeina
RoRo
Wâdi al Hasha
Wâdi al Hulayb
Ra's Suwayhil as Saghir
Mersa el Muqâbila
Merset Mahash el 'Ala
Merset Abu Samra
Wâdi el Malha
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b. We recognize that there are reports of a natural underwater land bridge at Nuweiba Beach. But there are some major problems. The crossing is 15.5 km wide.

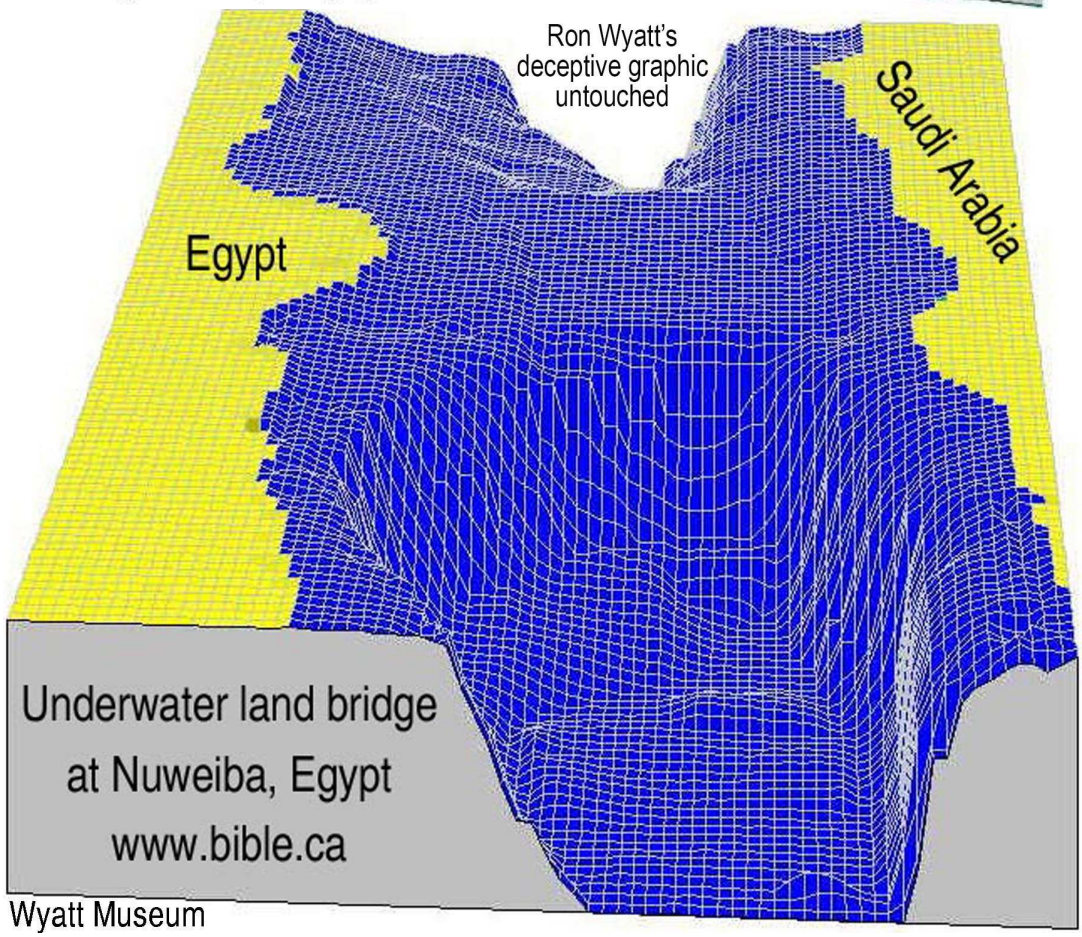
4. Here is a more recent map of the gulf of Aqaba from the University of Tel Aviv: **Israeli geological survey map by J.K. Hall and Z. Ben-Abraham**
   a. This Tel Aviv University data is more precise and DIFFERS in important area from the British Admiralty Chart 12 data. The center "trench" seem to start at 500m.
   b. The deepest depth is between 850-900 meters, not the 765m from the British Admiralty chart 12.
   c. According to the depth charts from Tel Aviv University, the land bridge is not as Wyatt claims. Wyatt's graphic with the dotted line gives the false impression that there are gentle slopes down and up as one travels from the Nuweiba Beach to Saudi Arabia. In fact, at ~1.6 km toward Saudi, the land bridge descends below Wyatt's extrapolated max depth of 240 m, to reach a depth of over 850 meters. Wyatt's gentile slope (~3°) does continue until ~4 km from the Sinai shore, but then descends steeply with a slope of ~11% (or at a 6.3° angle) before it flattens out into a U shape trench. It then ascends toward Arabia at a slope of 13% (or at a 7.5° angle). Note, the measure Tel Aviv University data is more than twice the slope Wyatt extrapolated. As a result Wyatt estimate of the passage depth as 240m was off by more than 360% — not a good margin or error. The 553m-tall CN tower is one of the tallest building in the world. This means Wyatt's extrapolation as to depth of the gulf was off by more than the CN Tower is tall.
   d. From the Egyptian western shore of the Nuweiba beach to the center of the deep at 850-900 Meters is a horizontal distance of 9 km. From the Saudi eastern shore to the centre of the deep is 6.5 km.
   e. The slope is at a constant unchanging pitch down to the deep from both sides.
   f. There is no gentle mantles on each shore followed by a sharp drop off.


Exodus Route
Straits of Tiran
Red Sea Crossing
Ezion-Geber (Edom)
1 Ki 9:26
The Impossible Nuweiba Crossing
15.5 km across
Egytian west shore to deep is 9 km
East shore to deep is 6.5 km
The slope is contsant to the bottom
from both shorelines without any shelf.
850-900 meters deep
ELAT DEEP
10 km
Scale
Nuweiba
Beech
The Etham Dilemma
"The Backtrack"
"Tell the sons of Israel to turn back & camp before Pi-hahiroth,between Migdol and the sea; you shall camp in front of Baal-zephon, opposite it, by the sea. "For Pharaoh will say of the sons of Israel, 'They are wandering aimlessly in the land; the wilderness has shut them in."
(Exodus 14:2–3)
ARAGONESE DEEP
ARENA DEEP
DAKAR DEEP
Midian
"Jethro"
Exodus 3:1
(el-Bad)
Wilderness of Egypt
Ezek 20:36 + Ex 15:1
Judges 11:16; Ex 13:18
Numbers 33:6
Numbers 33:8
3 days to Mariah
15 days to Sinai
Etham
"now turn back"

5. THESE ARE WYATT'S MISLEADING GRAPHICS:
   a. Wyatt's two graphics below do not represent the actual shape of the land bridge. They are not to scale and are deceptively misleading to the average reader.

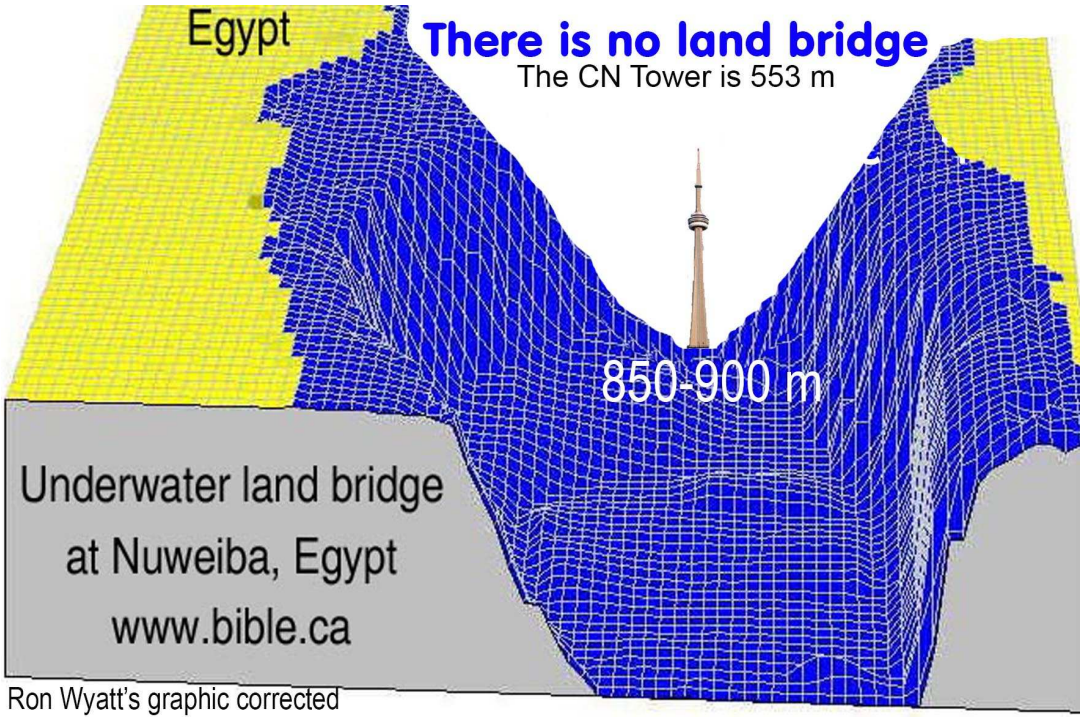


Ron Wyatt's deceptive graphic untouched



Wyatt Museum

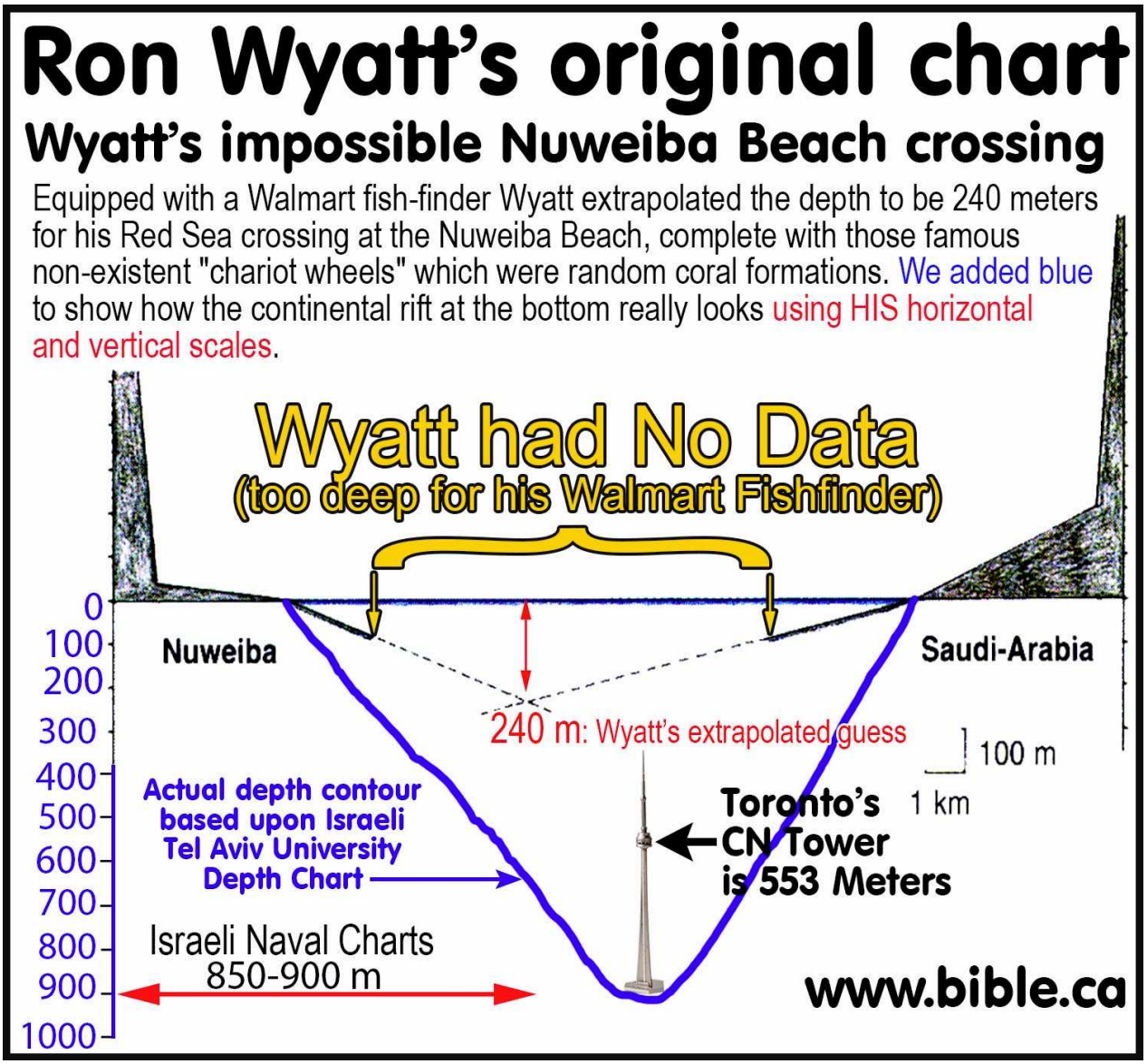
   b. The slope suggested by Wyatt is misleading and deceptive and above all ridiculous. Given a known depth of 765m, a slope of 1 in 14 would required 10.7 km (765 x 14) , and the return rise to Saudi with a slope of 1 in 10 would required 7.65 km (765 x 10). Combined these require a minimum span of 18.45 km, yet the distance from Nuweiba Beach to Saudi Arabia is only 16 km. There simply is not enough distance to support Wyatt claims.
   c. **WE CORRECTED WYATT'S DRAWING TO MAKE IT LOOK AS DEEP AS IN REALITY IT WOULD LOOK:**



Ron Wyatt's graphic corrected

d. The Straits of Tiran provide a max depth of 205 meters and are clearly a far superior choice for where Israel crossed the Red Sea.
e. We propose the Red Sea crossing at the Straits of Tiran.

6. **Modified depth chart from "The Exodus Case" (page 190), "The exodus Conspiracy" movie, by Lennart Moller.**



a. **THE ABOVE CHART IS RON WYATT'S.** The black lines, scales are his. We added the blue depth to show just how it really looks. So don't email the author an chastise him for how the horizonal scale is off. He chose the scale of 1 km horizonal to 100 meters vertical, not us.

b. The big problem with this depth chart is that is fails to supply any data at the critical needed point: the bottom of the middle! They took physical soundings with a video camera wire to about the 100 m depth from each shore, then extrapolated the bottom with the little black dotted line. This extrapolation produced a max depth of 240 meters in the middle. Now strangely you can go to home depot and buy a box of 300 meters of video cable for about $200. Why they stopped at only 100 meters is puzzling. Perhaps the only conspiracy here, is that they did not tell you that the ocean floor drops off rapidly at the 100 m depth. Having gone scuba diving twice in the gulf of Aqaba myself, I can tell you that the drop off is abrupt and dramatic and dangerous!

c. The British naval chart says the depth is 765 meters. The Israeli geological survey map by J.K. Hall and Z. Ben-Abraham says the depth is 800 meters.

d. We find the use of sport fishing depth finders and home made video camera cables of 100 meters to be unconvincing against the British and Israeli government conclusions.

7. **We did not rule out the Nuweiba Beach because 765m is too deep for God to part the sea!**

a. We chose the straits of Tiran over the Nuweiba Beach because it fits all the data perfectly not because God could not part 765 m of water. We accept the word of God as inspired. In fact we teach that when God created the heavens and the earth in six literal 24 hour days... He was taking his time! We oppose the theories of skeptics who only postulate naturalistic explanations for miracles and conclude they crossed the Red Sea at the freshwater Bitter lakes. Our God is all powerful and could part the Atlantic.

b. The grade is part of the issue at the Nuweiba Beach. Since the depth is 800 meters, not 240 m, this makes a huge difference! But God used miracles to assist the Israelites across the Red Sea. So our complaint with Wyatt's grades at the Neweiba Beech crossing, which Wyatt makes deceptively appear "consistent with the

American Disability Act", is that these gentle slopes do not exist at Neweiba! The grades are much steeper! Having said this, God could have performed the crossing at Neweiba as well! He gave them supernatural help! See this link: supernatural help.

c. The depth at the straits of Tiran is only 205 meters. But the distance for this drop is shorter, creating a steeper grade. We fully discuss this in detail at: Straits of Tiran. First, the Bible says God gave Israel supernatural help so that they would not stumble while crossing the Red Sea at the Straits of Tiran. Second, is it likely that in the past, the depth was less than what we see today and that the tides and currents have actually dug the depth deeper over time than it was 3500 years ago. Of course God could have performed a miracle and silted in the depth at both Tiran and Neweiba somewhat to make the bottom higher.

d. We propose the Red Sea crossing at the Straits of Tiran.

II. Ruling out candidates for Mt. Sinai:

1. **Green Light: Jebel Al-Lawz in north Saudi Arabia is Mt. Sinai:**
   a. This is the best candidate we have for Mt. Sinai. We are not aware of any reason Mt. Lawz could not be Mt. Sinai. Click here for discussion.
2. **Red Light: Traditional Mt. Musa rejected for being impossible**
   a. Although Mt. Musa, the traditional location for Mt. Sinai beside Saint Catherine's monastery located in the traditional Sinai Peninsula, cannot be excluded out of hand, there are other reasons for excluding it. It is well documented that most of her choices have been wrong. Since the Roman Catholic and Orthodox churches have both declared by edict, that Mt. Musa is Mt. Sinai, they have a great negative incentive to not question this choice. To do so, would call into question their foundation of tradition being wrong. No archeology from the time of the exodus (1446 BC) has been found connecting the Hebrews with the site.
3. **Red Light: Mt. [Gebel] Khashm et-Tarif and Darb Esh-Shairah or Shera rejected for being inside Egypt.** Gebel Khashm et-Tarif and nearby Esh-Shairah (Shera), must be rejected for a long series of unrecoverable problems:



   a. Since the border between Egypt and Israel has always been the Wadi-el Arish (river of Egypt), Mt. Khashm et-Tarif is well inside Egyptian controlled territory.
   b. It wrongly locates Midian in the Sinai rather than at El Bad in modern Saudi Arabia. The wilderness of Shur is the home turf of the Ishmaelite's. The Ishmaelite's and the Midianites are from the same area and are used interchangeably (repeatedly) in the story of Joseph being sold into Slavery.
   c. It ignores the fact that archeologically, the Edomites always lived Transjordan, until after the Babylonian

captivity of 587 BC.

d. It completely ignores the requirement for the Hebrews to travel through Ezion Geber, while on the 11 day route between Mt. Sinai and Kadesh Barnea (at Ein Qudeirat, which was a fortress of Solomon but not Kadesh). However, this objection evaporates if Kadesh is correctly located at El Beidha, 5 km north of Petra)

e. It wrongly makes Ezion-Geber the first stop after Mt. Sinai, instead of the last stop before Kadesh, as is seen in scripture.



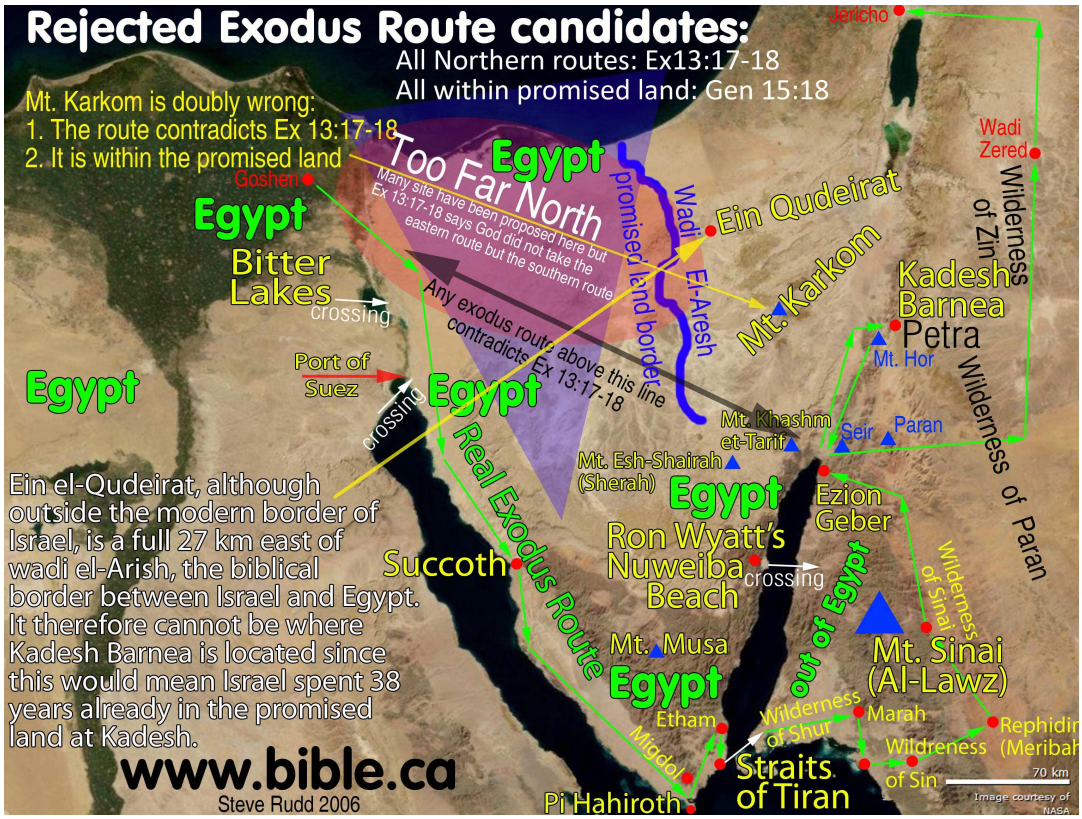
f. Israel crossed the Red Sea at Tiran on day 25, but it only took 15 days to get to Sinai.

g. The animal small stone artwork (Animal figures made of small stones) seen at Khashm et-Tarif, is common. For example it is seen in the Nahal Paran, complete with standing stones, cairns etc. and is found throughout the Negev, just like the rock art seen at Karkom, is seen in a wide geographic area in the Negev.

4. **Red Light: Mt. Karkom rejected for being within the promised land.**

a. Click here for discussion of Mt. Karkom.

b. All candidates for Mt. Sinai that are located north of a line drawn (see map below) from Goshen to Ezion Geber (Elat) contradict Ex 13:17-18. For example Mt. Karkom requires a route that is the same basic direct as the "way of the Philistines". God said he took them the long (southern) route.

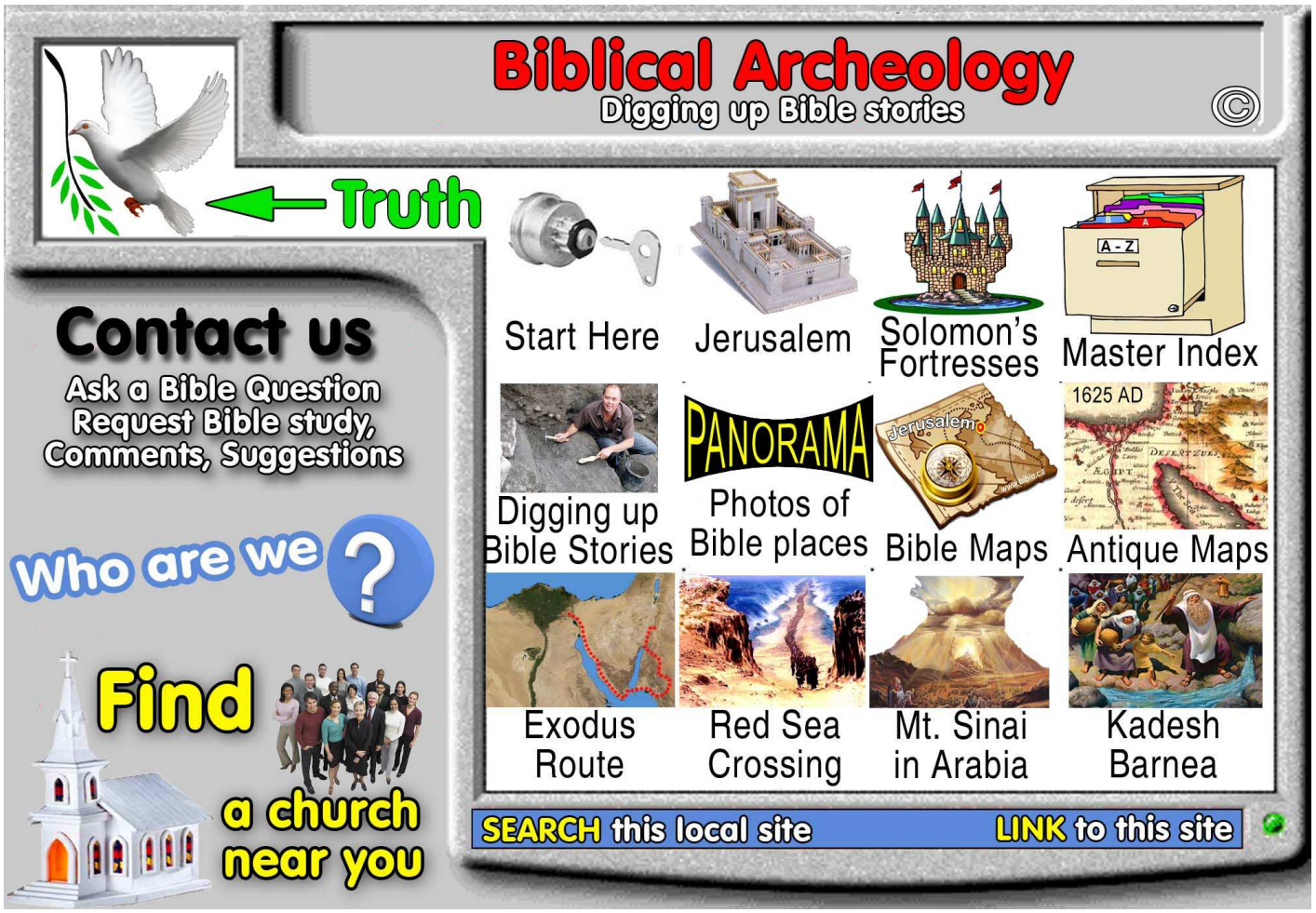


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III. Ruling out candidates for Kadesh Barnea

1. Green Light: The Petra area is where Kadesh Barnea is located: Using scripture, everyone before 1881 AD located Kadesh Barnea in the Arabah Valley, or near Petra. Eusebius stated that Kadesh and Mt. Hor were at Petra.
2. All candidates for or Kadesh Barnea that are within the promised land should be immediately rejected. Gen 15:18 sets the boundaries for the promised land between Egypt and Israel at the wadi El-Arish, known also as the "River of Egypt" in scripture. Judah's southern boundary was at the wadi el-Arish: Numbers 34:5; Joshua 15:1,4,47
3. Red light: Ein el-Qudeirat has been the almost universal choice for Kadesh Barnea since 1916 AD. While Ein el-Qudeirat is outside the modern border of Israel, it is a full 27 km east of wadi el-Arish, the biblical border between Israel and Egypt. It therefore cannot be where Kadesh Barnea is located since this would mean Israel spent 38 years already in the promised land at Kadesh.
4. Red light: Ein Qedeis was the choice for Kadesh Barnea from 1881 AD to 1916 AD. It is located only 10 miles south of Ein el-Qudeirat. Both should be reject out of hand on the simple basis that both are with the formal boundaries of the promised land.

By Steve Rudd, updated March 2018 AD: Contact the author for comments, input or corrections.



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